

HOW TO LEARN TUNES

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #79

Learning and memorizing songs is an important skill and pursuit for ALL students of jazz, at all levels. Someone who has the goal of becoming a professional will need to memorize songs, because that is part of the job description - you need to be able to show up and play hundreds of songs with no music stand, no music, no iPad. That is what pros do. They don't refer to cheat sheets, they don't carry milk crates of fake books, and they don't swipe left!

But, for the adult amateur or semi-pro who isn't going to become a full time pro, learning and memorizing songs is still VERY important, but for a different reason. The word "memorize" implies some level of "internalization." To memorize something, we need to get it "inside of us." To get good and to sound good, we need to get the songs we are playing inside us. Starting today, you'll have a great approach on how to begin doing this.

Many Songs Share The Same DNA! - here is a partial list (compiled with the help of my Face Book jazz friends) of some jazz compositions that share the same "A" section. Many of these songs are AABA compositions, so these eight measures of chord changes are literally 75% of most of the songs listed below. All of a sudden, the task isn't so daunting.

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|-------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------|
| - Take The A Train | - Darktown Strutters Ball | - Jersey Bounce |
| - Crazy Rhythm | - I Ain't Got Nobody | - Tricotism |
| - Desafinado | - Exactly Like You | - Chicago |
| - Undecided | - Watch What Happens | - I Got It Bad |
| - The Girl From Ipanema | - Mood Indigo | - Solitude |
| - So Danco Samba | - Lucky Southern | |

The "A" section of MANY Different Tunes

